

21번

A scientist named Speiser suspects that scallop vision works in a very different way than ours. Our brains combine the overlapping information from our two eyes into a single scene. A scallop could do the same across a hundred eyes, but that seems unlikely given how primitive its brain is. Instead, each eye might simply tell the brain whether it has detected something moving or not. Think of the scallop's brain as a security guard watching a bank of a hundred monitors, each connected to a motion-sensing camera. The cameras may be state-of-the-art, but the images they capture are not sent to the guard. All the guard sees on the monitors is a warning light for every camera that has spotted something. If Speiser is right about this strange setup, it means that even though each individual scallop eye has good spatial resolution, the animal itself might not have spatial vision. It knows when eyes in a certain region of its body have detected something, but it has no visual image of that object. It doesn't experience a movie in its head the same way we do. It sees without scenes.